

Single Page Applications that offer a great UI are intuitive and blazingly fast all the while running off the browser are the rage today. With the increasing popularity of such applications, rose the need to organise and structure the millions of lines of native JavaScript or jQuery code.

Make it reusable and modular, maintain code quality and enable easier testing of the entire application. In response to these problems a number of frameworks like Backbone.js and Ember.js came up with solutions each with their own approach towards it.

Angular is built on the premise that declarative code is easier to understand than imperative code when it comes to building UIs and wiring software components together, while the latter is excellent for implementing business logic. It is a very good idea to decouple DOM manipulation from app logic. This allows client-side apps to have the same level of modularity and reusability that we have all come to know and expect from traditional server-side apps.

This dramatically improves the testability of the code. In fact, testing client side apps were actually a bottleneck that many developers faced when designing a complex application as the only way to test scattered, verbose JavaScript applications was to go through the entire code execution manually and execute all its functionalities. Obviously, this is both time consuming and difficult to maintain, thus testing a client side app took a backseat in development. This not only caused major issues on ‘production-ready’ customer facing applications but hampered the productivity and turn around time of developers working on client side apps in general.

All this changed with the introduction of Angular that allowed modular code to be written, unit tested and reused all across the application without the verbosity of native JavaScript.

Angular vs The Competition

Of course, the open source community is teeming with frameworks that tries to solve the same problems that Angular does and some even manage to do a better job in a few situations, but the popularity of Angular as we will soon see, is well deserved.

Angular vs Backbone

While Angular is a complete framework for MVC and MVM architecture based rich internet applications, Backbone is primarily a templating frame-